Math alt-text rules

My role Editorial direction and accessibility SME review

I helped guide the rules for describing equations, tables, and graphs in math content. The examples show how spoken math can stay precise without overloading the reader.

ORIGINAL WORK FILE EXCERPT

General Alt Text Rules:

Always spell out math symbols such as negatives, operations, equality, etc.

: y equals negative 4 fifths x plus 3

$10.50: 10 dollars and 50 cents

As above, spell out fractions. Also spell out decimals using mathematical language.

4.56: 4 and 56 hundredths

Do not use quotation marks or parentheses unless the client asks for these.

A student says, “The sum is 20.” → A student says, the sum is 20.

Cost ($): Cost in dollars

For ordered pairs, do not use parentheses. Spell out the comma.

(4, –2): the point 4 comma negative 2

Separate numbers and letters used in sequence.

3x: 3 x

: triangle A B C